

RAUM AUF ZEIT

Location

Oldenburg, DE

Building Type

various vacant properties
(mainly commercial & retail spaces)

Reuse

temporary interim use for art,
culture & creative industries

Reusable Area

~ 15 - 100 m² (depending on the
project)

Governance Model

cooperation between the city +
a coordinating organisation

Project Start

since ~ 2020



Initial Situation

- Increasing vacancies in inner-city locations due to structural change
- Temporarily unused commercial spaces without immediate follow-up use
- Growing demand for space from creatives & initiatives
- Lack of affordable spaces for experimental uses

Reuse Strategy

Strategy: Mediation of vacant spaces to creatives for interim use with flexible durations & simple usage concepts

Temporary use includes:

- Exhibitions
- Workshops
- Pop-up projects

Character: temporary, flexible, low-threshold

Objectives

- Activation of vacant spaces on a temporary basis
- Provision of affordable spaces for creative uses
- Promotion of experimentation, exchange and visibility
- Positive impulses for urban development & revitalisation

Operational Concept

- Act as an intermediary between property owners & users
- Cooperation with the City of Oldenburg (*culture & urban development*)
- Organisation & support provided by RAZ

Key Actors

- **Main Operator:** RAZ - Raum auf Zeit UG
- **Partners:** City of Oldenburg (*Department for Culture, Museums & Sport*), Polygenos Kulturräume eG
- **Users:** creatives, initiatives, cultural practitioners

Key Features of the Project

- Systematic approach to matching vacant spaces with users
- Low barriers to entry for users
- Use as an experimental & testing ground
- Win-win model for property owners & creatives

Transferability

What makes this example particularly instructive?

- Shows how vacant spaces can be systematically mediated
- Demonstrates interim use as a strategic tool
- Strengthens creative use as part of urban development

Who is this model suitable for?

- Cities with temporary vacancies
- Municipalities with demand for creative uses
- Initiatives in the fields of culture & interim use
- Property owners without immediate follow-up use